

Los Angeles Crime Intelligence Report

Patterns, Trends and Victim Data Analysis Project

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1 Executive Summary

This analysis examines reported crime incidents in Los Angeles from 2020 to 2024 to identify key trends in crime frequency, patterns, geographic concentration, and victim demographics.

The findings show that crime increased significantly after the easing of COVID-19 restrictions, with 2022 recording the highest number of reported incidents. Crime is concentrated in a small number of areas, particularly Central, Southwest, and 77th Street divisions. Property and assault-related offences dominate the dataset, with identity theft ranking as the most reported crime.

Victim analysis indicates that males are recorded more commonly as victims, with individuals in their 30s representing the most affected age group. Hispanic/Latin/Mexican victims account for the largest number of reports, followed by Black and White victims.

These insights can help law enforcement agencies allocate resources more effectively and tailor prevention strategies to the areas, times, and communities most affected.

2 Objectives

The objectives of this data analysis are the following:

- Identify crime trends
- Determine peak hours
- Locate crime hotspots
- Analyse frequently committed crime types
- Provide strategic recommendations

3 Dataset Overview

3.1 Data collection

Dataset was obtained from [LA city website's API](#) via a simple Extract Transform Load (ETL) process. Raw data had more than 1 million rows and 28 columns. The dataset contains reported crime records from Los Angeles and includes the following key fields:

- `dr_no` – Incident identifier
- `date_reported`
- `date_occurred`
- `time_occurred`
- `area`
- `crime_desc`

- `vicit_age`
- `vicit_sex`
- `vict_descent`
- `weapon_desc`
- `status_desc`
- `address`

Data cleaning included transforming victim descent codes into readable categories such as Hispanic/Latin/Mexican, Black, White, and Other Asian. The ethnicity of the victim is fully identified in the field `vict_descent_full`

4 Methodology

The project was completed using:

- SQL for exploratory data analysis and advanced analytical queries.
- Tableau for interactive dashboards and stories.

Analyses included:

- Crime trends over time
- Hour-of-day analysis
- Hotspot identification
- Victim demographic analysis
- Crime category analysis

5 Key Findings

5.1 Crime Trends Over Time

Relative to COVID years (2020 and 2021), crimes have increased in 2022 and 2023 as pandemic restrictions were lifted.

2024 is a year to remember because crimes have reduced drastically and there is sharp downwards trend as shown in figure [1](#)



Figure 1: Crime trend over time from 2020 to 2024

5.1.1 Area trend

1. 77th Street was the leading crime hotspot in 2020 but **Central** which was in the second place in 2020 reaches the top from 2021 onwards.
2. 77th Street ranks second in the most committed crimes in LA from 2021 to 2023. Southwest takes the second spot in 2024.
3. Pacific was the third most crime reoccurring area after Central and 77th Street and occasionally beaten by Southwest.

5.1.2 Crime type trend

1. **Stolen Vehicle** is the most committed crime every year with more than 20,000 vehicles stolen every year.
2. Battery - Simple Assault was the second most committed crimes in 2020, 2021 and 2023. Identity Theft and Burglary from Vehicle were the runners up in 2022 and 2024.
3. Vandalism was dominant in the third place in 2020 and 2021 but Battery - Simple Assault, Burglary and Shoplifting (Petty theft under \$950) ranked at third most committed crime in 2023, 2024 and 2025 respectively.

5.1.3 Peak Crime hours trend

1. Every year over 13,000 crimes are committed at noon (12 PM) but dropping to nearly 8000 crimes in 2024.
2. The second and third most crime peak hour occurs between 17:00 to 19:00 followed by 20:00.
3. Period of day - Crimes at Night (09:00 PM to 5:00 AM) dominated with over 55,000 crimes every year from 2020 to 2023. Afternoon (12:00 PM to 5 PM) crimes were the second most period of the day from 2020 to 2023 with over 54,000 crimes.

5.1.4 Victim Age Group

Many crimes do not have victims' age recorded and thus they are classified as NULL. These unrecorded victims are the most affected every year with over 50,000 crimes committed against them since 2021.

1. Victims in their 30s are the leading age group affected every year.
2. Victims in their 20s are the second most affected every year.
3. A pattern follows as Victims in their 40s then 50s and 60s rank third, fourth and fifth respectively every year.

5.1.5 Victim Gender trend

1. Male victims are the most affected gender every year with over 80,000 crimes.
2. Female victims are the second most affected gender where there is a steady increase from 2020 to 2022.
3. Gender X victims are the third most affected yet there is sharp increase in crimes every year.

5.1.6 Victim Ethnicity trend

1. Hispanic victims are the most affected with over 60,000 crimes reported every year.
2. White victims are the second most affected with over 40,000 crimes reported year.
3. Black victims are the third most affected with over 30,000 crimes reported every year.

5.2 Peak Crime Hour

Overall, for all areas, the peak crime hour is between **12 PM and 1 PM**.

5.2.1 Top 3 Crimes type at Peak Crime Hour

1. 10,380 - Identity Theft
2. 5,102 - Vehicle Stolen
3. 4,700 - Theft-Plain - Petty (Under \$950)

5.2.2 Top 3 Areas at Peak Crime Hour

1. 4,292 - Pacific
2. 4,108 - Central
3. 3,898 - 77th Street

5.2.3 Victim profile at Peak Crime Hour

There were over 15,000 records that doesn't have victims' age, 5,502 records with no gender and 7,968 records with no ethnicity at peak crime hour.

The following victims were targeted at 12 to 1 PM

- Victim Gender
 1. Both Male and Female victims were almost equally targeted but women (27,195) slightly edge over men (27,113) as a victim.
- Victim Age Group
 1. 13,179 in their 30s
 2. 11,385 in their 20s
 3. 9,012 in their 40s
- Victim Ethnicity
 1. 19,251 - Hispanic
 2. 15,786 - White
 3. 9,682 - Black

For interactive viz, please click the tableau link and go to [Crime Patterns Hotspot Dashboard](#).

5.2.4 Crimes by period of the day

Period of the day is grouped as the following:

- Morning 5:00 AM to 11:59 AM
- Afternoon 12:00 PM to 4:59 PM
- Evening 5:00 PM to 8:59 PM
- Night 9:00 PM to 4:59 AM

As expected, data confirms intuition that most crimes are committed at night between 9:00 PM and 5:00 AM where stolen vehicle tops the chart.

Night

1. Central has 19,748, 77th Street has 18,117 and Hollywood has 16,742 seen at night time.
2. Stolen Vehicle at 37,199 and Burglary from Vehicle at 21,557 and Vandalism at 19,639 were recorded as the top 3 crime types.
3. 113,857 were male and 97,291 were female victims.
4. Victims in their 20s and 30s were the most affected with a combined total of 114,932 crimes.
5. Hispanic community victims are at the top of the chart with 85,768 crimes reported, followed by White victims at 52,904.

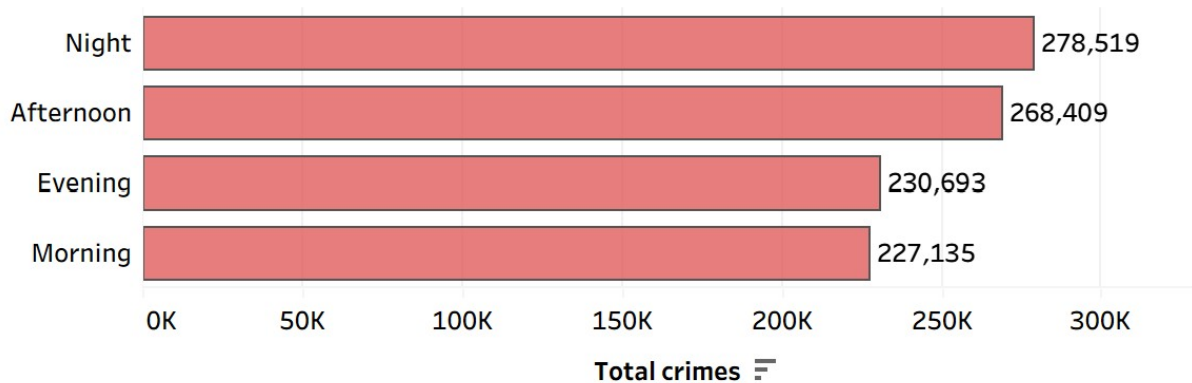


Figure 2: Total Crimes by period of the day

5.3 Geographic Hotspots

Top 3 crime hotspot areas in LA are:

1. 69,654 - Central
2. 61,755 - 77th Street
3. 59,507 - Central

5.3.1 Top 3 Crime types at crime hotspot (Central)

1. 9,695 - Burglary from Vehicle
2. 6,806 - Battery Simple Assault
3. 5,050 - Vehicle - Stolen

5.3.2 Top Crime hours at crime hotspot (Central)

1. Overall, 19,748 crimes were committed at night but the in the evening at 6 PM is where most criminal activity (4,188) had occurred.
2. 17,649 crimes were reported in the afternoon.
3. 16,549 crimes were reported in the morning.

5.3.3 Victim profile at crime hotspot (Central)

1. 17,787 Hispanic Victims, 13,516 Black and 12,289 White Victims were affected at Central.
2. 33,629 Males, 21,343 Females and 8,714 Gender X victims were affected.
3. Victims in their 20s and 30s are the most affected with a combined total crimes 30,893.

For interactive viz, please click the tableau link and go to [Crime Patterns Hotspot Dashboard](#).

5.4 Most Common Crime Types

The most frequently reported offences for all areas combined in order were:

Crime Description	Total Crimes
Vehicle - Stolen	115183
Battery - Simple Assault	74821
Burglary from Vehicle	63515
Theft of Identity	62521
Vandalism - Felony (\$400 & over)	61070

5.4.1 Areas by most common crime

1. 8,766 vehicles stolen at 77th Street
2. 8,281 vehicles stolen at Newton
3. 7,241 vehicles stolen at Southeast

5.4.2 Peak crime hour for most common crime

Night (36,994) and Evening (32,745) times are when the citizens of LA are most vulnerable of getting their vehicles stolen especially the window between 3 PM to midnight.

5.4.3 Victim profile by Crime type

The dataset doesn't provide enough victim information for stolen vehicle since the victims' age, gender and ethnicity are filled with NULL values.

5.5 Victim Gender

Male victims (403,816) were recorded slightly more than female victims (around 90000). However, some crimes were predominantly targeted at women. There were 144,630 records that doesn't have victim's gender recorded.

5.5.1 Male Victims by Area

1. 33,629 crimes at Central
2. 25,373 crimes at N Hollywood
3. 23,662 crimes at Pacific

5.5.2 Male Victims by Crime Type

1. 39,213 - Battery - Simple Assault
2. 38,171 - Assault with deadly weapon, Aggravated Assault
3. 35,399 - Burglary from Vehicle

5.5.3 Male Victims at Crime peak hour

1. 113,857 crimes were reported at night
2. 109,012 crimes were reported in the afternoon
3. 90,860 crimes were reported in the morning

5.5.4 Male Victims by Ethnicity

1. 147,426 crimes were against Hispanic males
2. 116,496 crimes were against White males
3. 59,411 crimes were against Black males

5.5.5 Male Victims age group

1. Victims in their 30s are the most affected with 99,170 crimes recorded.
2. 80,283 crimes were against victims in their 20s.
3. Victims in their 40s are third most affected at 68,609 crimes.

5.5.6 Female Victims by Area

1. 26,854 crimes at reported at 77th Street
2. 22,763 crimes at Southwest
3. 21,864 crimes at Southeast

5.5.7 Female Victims by Crime type

1. 35,800 Identity thefts
2. 35,507 Intimate Partner - Simple Assault
3. 35,134 Battery - Simple Assault

5.5.8 Female Victims at crime peak hours

1. 99,178 crimes were in the afternoon
2. 97,291 crimes were at night
3. 85,872 crimes were in the morning

5.5.9 Female Victims age group

1. Women in their 30s are the most affected with 95,115 crimes reported.
2. 91,878 crimes reported for women in their 20s.
3. 60,989 crimes reported for women in their 40s.

5.5.10 Female Victims Ethnicity

1. Hispanic women have high records of crimes reported at 148,703
2. White women are second to Hispanic women at 84,605 crimes
3. Black women are at 76,220

5.6 Victim Age Groups

5.6.1 Crimes against Children

There are 10,797 crimes reported where victims are children aged 13 and under. Here is the breakdown by features and their corresponding number of crimes

- **Top Areas**

1. 77th Street - 1,085
2. Southeast - 881
3. Southwest - 799

- **Top Crime types**

1. Child Abuse (Physical) - 2,173
2. Battery - Simple Assault - 1,407
3. Crimes against child (13 or under) - 1,392
4. Child neglect - 812
5. Assault with deadly weapon, aggravated assault - 705

- **Peak Crime hours**

1. 12 PM - 1,397
2. 3 PM - 926
3. 4 PM - 692

- **Victim Gender**

1. Female - 6,203
2. Male - 4,451

- **Victim Ethnicity**

1. Hispanic - 6,970
2. Black - 2,120
3. White - 952

5.6.2 Crimes against Elderly (70+)

For elderly citizens aged 70 and above, there were 31,587 crimes reported.

- **Top Area**

1. 2,814 in West LA
2. 2,218 in Devonshire
3. 2,178 in West Valley

- **Top Crime types**

1. 4,125 Burglaries
2. 3,440 Identity thefts
3. 3,307 Battery - Simple Assaults

- **Peak Crime Hours**

1. 11,167 in the Afternoon
2. 8,654 in the morning
3. 6,036 at night

- **Victim Gender**

1. 16,004 Male victims
2. 15,496 Female victims

- **Victim Ethnicity**

1. 14,133 White victims
2. 6,777 Hispanic victims
3. 4,639 Black victims

5.7 Victim Ethnicity

144,642 crimes do not have victim's ethnicity recorded. Aside from this, Hispanic community are the most vulnerable especially women since the male-to-female ratio is 0.99.

5.7.1 Top Areas affecting Hispanic victims

1. 22,756 crimes at Newton
2. 20,981 crimes at Mission
3. 20,148 crimes at 77th Street

5.7.2 Crime type against most vulnerable Ethnicity

Top 5 crime types committed against Hispanic community:

1. Battery - Simple Assault - 37,553
2. Assault with deadly weapon, Aggravated Assault - 26,615
3. Intimate Partner - Simple Assault - 24,669
4. Identity Theft - 20,014
5. Burglary from Vehicle - 19,282

5.7.3 Peak crime hours against Hispanic victims

1. 85,768 crimes at night
2. 77,337 crimes in the afternoon
3. 67,267 crimes in the morning

5.8 Hispanic Victim Gender

1. 148,703 crimes against women
2. 147,426 crimes against men

5.8.1 Hispanic Victim Age group

1. 77,819 in their 20s
2. 76,828 in their 30s
3. 54,225 in their 40s

5.9 Weapon Analysis

677,552 crimes do not have weapon recorded. This could be a case of identity theft, stolen vehicles, vandalism, shoplifting, stolen goods, etc.

1. 174,736 crimes recorded Strong-arm / body force as the most used weapon
2. 36,386 crimes have unknown weapon
3. 23,840 crimes have verbal threat
4. 20,182 crimes have hand gun
5. 7,266 crimes have semi automatic pistol

5.10 Lethal Weapons

5.10.1 Weapons used by areas

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

5.11 Violent crimes

In this analysis, I have classified violent crimes are the following:

Arson	Assault with a deadly weapon, Aggravated Assault
Battery with sexual contact	Child Abandonment
Child Abuse (Simple & Aggravated)	Child Neglect
Child Stealing	Criminal Homicide
CRM AGNST CHLD (13 or under)	Drugs to Minor
Firearms (Discharge)	Human Trafficking
Inciting a Riot	Intimate Partner - Aggravated Assault
Kidnapping	Lynching
Manslaughter	Oral Copulation
Rape	Robbery
Shots fired (any form)	Sexual unlawful / Penetration W/ Foreign object
Sodomy/Sexual contact	Weapons possession / Bombing

Table 1: Violent crimes

5.11.1 Violent crime areas

1. 14,631 - 77th Street
2. 11,216 - Southeast
3. 9,262 - Central
4. 8,611 - Southwest
5. 8,500 - Newton

5.11.2 Violent Crime Types

1. 53,522 Assaults with deadly weapons, Aggravated Assault
2. 32,315 Robberies
3. 12,656 Intimate Partner - Aggravated Assault
4. 4,162 Battery with sexual contact
5. 3,756 Rape

5.11.3 Violent crime peak hours

1. 45,035 at night
2. 31,777 in the afternoon
3. 28,291 in the evening

5.11.4 Violent crimes victim age

1. 30,267 victims in their 20s
2. 27,014 victims in their 30s
3. 17,731 victims in their 40s
4. 12,681 victims in their 50s
5. 7,020 child victims and 7,716 teenagers (14 to 17)

5.11.5 Violent crimes victim gender

1. 69,713 Male victims
2. 50,145 Female victims
3. 9,838 Gender X victims

5.11.6 Violent crimes victim ethnicity

1. 60,242 Hispanic victims
2. 30,001 Black victims
3. 18,159 White victims

6 Analytical Interpretation

- The increase in crime after 2021 likely reflects increased public activity as lockdown restrictions were lifted.
- Midday and early evening peaks suggest crimes occur during commuting, shopping, and rush hours.
- Identity theft (10,380) is more than twice the number of stolen vehicles (5,102).
- A small number of areas account for a disproportionate share of incidents, supporting hotspot-focused policing.
- Property and financial crimes are major contributors to overall crime volume.
- Working-age adults, particularly males, are the most frequently represented victims.
- Victim descent findings should be interpreted in the context of underlying population distribution and reporting behavior. More analysis required.

7 Operational Recommendations

7.1 Patrol Deployment

- Increase visible patrols in Central, Southwest, and 77th Street.
- Focus deployment between 12 PM to 1 PM and 5 PM to 6 PM.

7.2 Property Crime Prevention

- Expand public education on identity theft prevention.
- Increase surveillance and patrols in areas with high vehicle burglary rates.

7.3 Community Engagement

- Conduct targeted outreach in communities with higher victimization counts.
- Provide safety guidance for working-age adults.
- LAPD should liaise with other government bodies to raise awareness to communities on theft related crimes such as identity theft, stolen vehicles, petty theft, burglary, etc.
- Awareness through documentaries, school/college visits, social media, etc such as putting car keys in a tin foil can blocking radio signals and preventing car thefts

7.4 Analytical Monitoring

- Track year-over-year changes by area and offence type.
- Monitor shifts in hotspot locations over time.
- Analyze case status and reporting delays.

8 Limitations

- Analysis is based on reported crimes only.
- Reporting rates may differ across communities.
- Victim descent counts are not adjusted for population size.
- Some records may contain missing or unknown values.

9 Conclusion

Crime in Los Angeles increased notably after 2020, with incidents concentrated in specific locations and time periods. Stolen Vehicles, Identity thefts, Battery - Simple Assault crimes dominate the city, while working-age male and Hispanic community victims are most frequently represented.

These findings support targeted patrol deployment, prevention strategies, and continued analytical monitoring to improve public safety outcomes.

There are too many NULL values present in the data especially in victim's age. Data collecting officers should be notified of this missing data thus improving data integrity.